



*King Minos ruled the island of Crete,
but he was a greedy monarch, and he had
been trying to conquer the Greek city
of Athens for some time.*

After many years of fighting, the Athenians ran short of food and they surrendered to Minos. The victorious king demanded that each year the Athenians send to him seven boys and seven girls so that they could be fed to the Minotaur—a dreadful beast, half-man, half-bull, that Minos kept trapped in an endless maze known as the Labyrinth. The Labyrinth prevented the monster from terrorizing the people of Crete, but it also stopped the boys and girls from escaping.

*No one had ever made their way
out of the Labyrinth alive.*

Three years after Athens had surrendered, the Athenian prince Theseus had had enough: “This year I am going to Crete to kill the Minotaur once and for all!” he announced.

His father, King Aegeus, was worried. “Theseus, promise me that if you survive, you will fly white sails on your ship, so I can see you are returning safely,” he asked.